# Nikhil Acharya Prakash

**Solana & crypto infrastructure · 15 years in systems software**

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## SUMMARY

Engineer and technical leader building crypto infrastructure on Solana. Currently at the Solana Foundation working on token data, transaction relaying (Kora), RPC monitoring and trading infrastructure; previously a founding engineer at Helius, indexing NFTs and tokens and scaling RPC. Before crypto: WAN acceleration, switch operating systems, unikernels and serverless platforms.

## EXPERIENCE

**Solana Foundation** May 2026 – Present

- Modernized key products while cutting cost and vendor dependency: led the Tokens rebuild, set up Kora on devnet and mainnet, and moved Breeze onto standard infrastructure.
- Designed and built the foundation of the trading infrastructure, with multi-region redundancy, monitoring and failover from day one.
- Released a public RPC monitoring dashboard for RPC providers.
- Set up a common engineering operating model: design, release and incident templates, on-call and escalation, and a "How to Build" onboarding guide.

**Helius**, Bangalore · Founding Engineer / Principal Engineer Mar 2023 – May 2026

- Indexed Solana compressed NFTs and NFTs as open standards; added regular tokens, token extensions and a new RWA indexer.
- Built a global rate limiter and edge caching for RPC traffic worldwide.
- Led the user-management revamp for the Helius developer portal; improved gRPC-based Solana WebSockets.

**DigitalOcean**, Bangalore · Engineering Manager / Technical Lead Sep 2021 – Feb 2023

- Led the team integrating the Nimbella serverless platform into multiple regions as DigitalOcean Cloud Functions after the acquisition.
- Built control-plane services and APIs for Cloud Functions; delivered Scheduled Functions and function eventing.

**Nimbella**, Bangalore · Founding Engineer / Technical Lead Sep 2019 – Aug 2021

- Led integrations with Netlify and Postman; managed the team building Commander for Slack and Microsoft Teams.
- Integrated the OpenWhisk API Gateway into the Nimbella serverless stack.

**Arista Networks**, Bangalore · Member of Technical Staff Nov 2017 – Aug 2019

- Wireshark and tcpdump dissectors for Arista's proprietary protocol; VRF and HA for management interfaces on Arista switches.

**IBM Research**, New York · Researcher Sep 2018 – Dec 2018

- Research on "Unikernels as Processes", published at ACM SoCC 2018; ran Solo5 unikernels as Docker containers, leading to Nabla containers.

**Aryaka Networks**, Bangalore · Member of Technical Staff Jul 2011 – Sep 2017

- Led the IP Acceleration delivery team; improved resource use, bandwidth and connection throughput of Aryaka's cloud; built POP-level redundancy, control-plane rate limiting and DDoS mitigation for IKEv1.

## PROJECTS

- **Pillar**: open-source agent and controller for running Solana validators: supervise, self-heal, provision, upgrade (Rust, gRPC). pillar.niks3089.com
- **Portfolio**: self-hosted multi-wallet Solana tracker with trade-based P&L, XIRR and an end-to-end encrypted vault (TypeScript). portfolio.niks3089.com
- **Brigade**: crypto-native social network for Solana (Rust, PostgreSQL, NATS JetStream). brigade.niks3089.com
- **TechShorts**: tech news in 60 words; Rust ingest pipeline with LLM summaries, served as static JSON. techshorts.niks3089.com
- **Open source**: IncludeOS (IPv6 stack, Node.js and DPDK ports), Solo5 (core dumps, 3x network bandwidth via shared memory).

## SKILLS

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| **Crypto** | Solana, RPC and indexing, token data, transaction relaying, trading and validator infrastructure |
| **Systems** | Distributed systems, cloud-native services, serverless, networking, systems software |
| **Languages** | Rust, Go, TypeScript, Python, C/C++ |
| **Leadership** | Engineering standards, on-call and incident process, hiring, mentoring, planning |

## EDUCATION

**BITS Pilani**, M.Tech
**BMS College of Engineering**, Bangalore · B.E. Computer Science